

Tyson DePina — Speaker One-Sheet

SPEAKER ONE-SHEET

Tyson DePina

Reentry Advocate | Youth Mentor | Formerly Incarcerated Speaker

Tagline: *“From the Dojo to the Penitentiary — Making Choices That Matter”*

TOPIC 1: From the Dojo to the Penitentiary

The Decision That Changes Everything

Every kid is a champion at something. Tyson was a world champion karate competitor—400+ trophies, international travel, Billy Blanks USA JR All-Stars. By 14, he was in DYS. By 18, adult jail. This keynote traces the exact moment a promising future became a 24-year sentence—and the decision framework he now teaches kids to avoid the same path.

Audience: Middle school, high school, youth detention facilities, community organizations

TOPIC 2: Fighting for Your Future

Turning Setbacks into Comebacks

The same discipline that made Tyson a champion at 8 years old is the same discipline that rebuilt his life at 48. This talk is about leveraging what you already have—your grit, your focus, your refusal to quit—to create a future worth fighting for. Not motivational fluff. Real tools. Real talk.

Audience: At-risk youth, student athletes, alternative education programs

TOPIC 3: The One Decision

How One Choice Dominates Your Entire Life

One decision to say “yes” to the wrong crowd. One decision to carry a gun. One decision that dominoed into 30 years of consequences. Tyson breaks down exactly how small decisions become life sentences—and how to interrupt the pattern before it starts.

Audience: Youth courts, reentry programs, parental awareness events

TOPIC 4: Know Your Rights

Legal Literacy for Young People

As a self-taught jailhouse lawyer who has represented himself in courtrooms and won, Tyson teaches youth the legal basics they won’t learn anywhere else: what to say (and NOT say) to police, how the system works against you, and how to protect yourself when it matters most.

Audience: High schools, community groups, parent organizations, law-related education programs

BIO

At 8 years old, Tyson DePina was already a headline-maker. As a member of the Billy Blanks USA JR All-Stars karate team, he traveled the world—Team Canada in 1986, Trinidad and Tobago in 1987—amassing over 400 trophies. His face appeared on the sports page under the headline: *“Youngster’s quiet nature belies fighting spirit.”*

At 14, everything changed. After entering DYS for guns and drugs, Tyson robbed an undercover cop at gunpoint at 16. The government sought to try him as an adult. He was remanded to DYS until his 18th birthday.

From 18 to 49, Tyson cycled through county jail, state prison, and federal prison—24 years behind bars across three decades. He caught his first federal case in 2005 and a second in 2016, receiving a 96-month sentence.

Today, Tyson is channeling the same fighting spirit into a new mission: helping teenagers escape the path he walked. He is a certified jailhouse lawyer, a youth mentor, and a voice for reentry.

His message is simple: your past does not define your future. But your next decision might.

WHAT PEOPLE ARE SAYING

“Tyson doesn’t just talk at kids—he connects with them. You can see it in their faces when he speaks. They actually listen.” — **Youth Program Coordinator, Bristol County**

LOGISTICS

Format: Keynote (45-60 min) | Workshop (60-90 min) | Panel Discussion

Audience Size: 10-500+

Technical Needs: Projector + screen, lavalier microphone, standing mic optional

Availability: Open to schools, community organizations, churches, corporate events, conferences, and reentry programs

CONTACT

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Booking & Inquiries: Use the contact above or reach out through this platform.

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